PATIN / TERO!

Section 5 - Economy, Shop, and Unit Progression

Game Design Document | Reconstructed Draft v1.0 | For review before finalization

Section 5 defines how players acquire characters, manage coins, build their rosters, and strengthen their teams throughout a tournament. The economy creates decisions between immediate team improvements and saving resources for later rounds. It connects to the character system in Section 4 and tournament progression in Section 2.

This section retains the established five-offer shop, two-coin reroll, nine-slot bench, and three-copy merging system. Numerical values not yet confirmed are marked provisional.

5.1 Economy System Overview

PATIN / TERO! uses a match-based economy in which players earn coins through tournament participation and spend them during planning phases. Coins are the primary gameplay currency, used to purchase characters and reroll the shop. The economy operates entirely between battles.

1. Earn Coins - Receive starting resources and round rewards.

2. Open Shop - Review five available character offers.

3. Purchase Units - Add characters to the bench or eligible roster.

4. Merge Units - Combine three identical same-star characters.

5. Deploy and Program - Prepare offensive and defensive formations.

6. Battle and Repeat - Resolve the match and return to planning.

The economy should remain accessible without requiring extensive traditional auto-battler knowledge.

5.2 Currency System

The game uses one primary currency: **Coins**. Coins are earned and spent within the current tournament session and do not carry over between tournaments.

5.2.1 Currency Sources

- Starting tournament resources.
- Base income after each completed round.
- Applicable match performance bonuses.
- Other explicitly defined tournament rewards.
- A 2-0 result earns a performance bonus.

5.2.2 Currency Uses

Action	Coin cost
Purchase character	Based on character cost
Reroll shop	2 coins
Deploy character	Free
Equip / reorder moveset cards	Free
Merge matching characters	Free
Open or close shop	Free

5.2.3 Currency Rules

Players cannot spend more coins than they possess. The authoritative game state validates every transaction. Failed purchases and rerolls do not deduct coins. Coin balances are nonnegative integers.

5.3 Starting Resources and Round Income

Every player begins with equal starting coins, giving all participants the same initial purchasing opportunities.

5.3.1 Starting Coins

The exact starting amount remains to be finalized. It should support a functional initial formation without an excessively long purchasing phase.

5.3.2 Base Round Income

Surviving players receive fixed base income after each completed tournament round, including rounds they perform poorly in.

5.3.3 Performance Bonus

Winning both arenas with a 2-0 result awards an additional coin reward, encouraging balanced offense and defense.

Match result	Economic treatment
2-0	Base income plus 2-0 bonus
1-1	Base income
0-2	Base income

Bonus amount and base income values remain unconfirmed.

5.3.4 Income Timing

Income is awarded after round results are finalized, before the next planning phase. Eliminated players receive no income for subsequent rounds.

5.4 Shop System

The shop is the primary method for acquiring characters. It presents five character offers and is accessed during planning as a modal window over the persistent 3D arenas.

5.4.1 Shop Availability

The shop opens and closes freely during planning. While open, it captures input and blocks arena interactions. It is unavailable during active battles.

5.4.2 Shop Offers

Each of the five offers shows a character identity, role, cost, and purchase availability. Offers follow configured shop distribution rules.

5.4.3 Purchasing Characters

- Validate available coins.
- Validate capacity to receive the unit.
- Deduct the correct coin amount.
- Create a new one-star character instance.
- Add it to the player roster, normally via the bench.
- Mark the purchased offer sold or empty.
- Evaluate any automatic merge.

A purchase is atomic: players must never lose coins without receiving the character.

5.4.4 Shop Wireframe Notes

The planning-phase modal shows five offer cards, current coin balance, a Reroll (2 coins) control, and a close control. Illustrative names include Habulin, Harang, Liksi, Sentro, and Tukso; names and character prices are provisional.

5.5 Shop Reroll System

Rerolling replaces all five offers with a new set at a fixed cost of **2 coins**.

5.5.1 Reroll Rules

- Reroll costs exactly 2 coins.
- All five shop offers are replaced.
- Insufficient coins prevent rerolling.
- Rerolls occur only during planning.
- Already purchased characters remain unchanged.
- Deployed formations and movesets remain unchanged.

5.5.2 Offer Generation

Offer generation should use a defined character pool and reproducible random number generator. Resulting offers are recorded in authoritative tournament state. Probability distribution, character availability, and duplicate-offer rules remain to be balanced.

5.6 Character Purchase Costs

Per-character purchase prices are not yet confirmed and should not be fabricated. Each character definition needs these fields:

Field	Purpose
Character ID	Unique roster identifier
Purchase cost	Coins required to buy one copy
Shop weight	Relative appearance probability
Availability	Eligibility for shop pool
Role	Runner, horizontal guard, or center guard

Purchase prices must be visible before transactions. Star upgrades are achieved by merging rather than directly purchasing upgraded units.

5.7 Bench and Roster Management

The player bench holds up to **nine character instances** not currently deployed.

5.7.1 Bench Rules

- Nine slots maximum, one unit per slot.
- Units may move between valid anchors and free bench slots during planning.
- Bench units do not participate in battle.
- Benched units retain identity, star level, and card configuration.
- Bench management stops when the formation locks.

5.7.2 Bench Capacity

A purchase needing an extra slot is rejected when the bench is full unless a valid merge or supported roster action frees capacity. Purchased units are never silently discarded.

5.7.3 Deployed and Bench Units

Deployed units occupy valid arena anchors; bench units remain available for future deployment or merging. Both are player-owned roster units and may participate in valid merges during planning.

5.8 Unit Merging and Star Progression

Three identical units of the same star level combine into one of the next level: **three 1-star units produce one 2-star unit; three 2-star units produce one 3-star unit**. Three stars is the maximum.

5.8.1 Merge Requirements

- Same character ID.
- Same star level.
- Same owning player.
- Eligible for merging during planning.

5.8.2 Automatic Merging

The MVP may automatically merge when a third matching copy becomes available, reducing repetitive inventory management. Resolve merges before final roster validation.

5.8.3 Merge Result

Star level	Equipped signature cards
1 star	1 card
2 stars	2 distinct cards
3 stars	3 distinct cards

Merging never changes character role or valid deployment anchors.

5.8.4 Merge Position and Card Inheritance

Provisional MVP rule: Retain an eligible deployed unit anchor where possible; otherwise place the upgraded unit on the bench. Revalidate equipment after upgrading. Multiple-deployed-copy priority remains to be finalized.

5.9 Roster Capacity and Deployment Limits

Unit category	Maximum deployed
Runners	3
Horizontal guards	3
Center guards	1
Total active units	7
Bench slots	9

The roster may contain more units than can be deployed. Purchasing or merging cannot bypass arena role limits or bench capacity.

5.10 Economy Strategy and Player Decisions

5.10.1 Immediate Strength Versus Saving

Spending now can improve current results; saving preserves future purchasing flexibility.

5.10.2 Purchasing Versus Rerolling

Players choose between current offers and spending two coins to search for better ones. Excessive rerolling reduces funds for purchases.

5.10.3 Roster Variety Versus Merging

A diverse roster increases tactical options, while duplicates create upgrade opportunities. Players balance variety against card capacity.

5.10.4 Offense Versus Defense Investment

Investing heavily in runners may weaken defense; focusing only on guards may limit offense. The 2-0 bonus rewards balanced team building.

5.11 Tournament Economy Progression

Stage	Players	Economy focus
Opening	8	Build functional initial roster and formations.
Early elimination	6	Address weak roles and pursue merges.
Mid tournament	4	Refine specialized moveset combinations.
Finalists	2	Optimize existing roster for championship.
Championship	1 winner	Resolve final match and declare champion.

5.11.1 Championship Shop Restriction

The shop is disabled during the championship rematch. Finalists rely on existing rosters, subject to permitted formation and moveset adjustments.

5.11.2 Economy Reset

Coins, shop offers, roster instances, and upgrades reset after the tournament. No permanent competitive advantage carries into the next session.

5.12 Shop User Interface Requirements

5.12.1 Required Information

- Character name and portrait or 3D preview.
- Role and purchase cost.
- Purchase availability.
- Relevant star or ownership information when useful.
- Current coin balance and 2-coin reroll cost.

5.12.2 Shop Interaction

Click an offer to purchase. Unaffordable offers are disabled. Disable reroll below two coins. Closing the modal restores planning-arena interaction.

5.12.3 Shop Feedback

Provide immediate confirmation for purchases and distinct notifications for merges. Failed transactions explain insufficient coins or roster capacity.

5.13 Economy Data and Configuration

Economy values should be configurable data resources, not hard-coded into UI components.

Field	Configuration
Starting coins	To be confirmed
Base round income	To be confirmed

Field	Configuration
2-0 win bonus	To be confirmed
Shop reroll cost	2 coins
Shop offer count	5
Bench capacity	9
Character costs	Per-character configuration
Shop offer weights	Per-character configuration
Merge requirement	3 matching copies
Maximum star level	3

Dedicated game systems validate and apply purchases, rerolls, and merges. UI components only request these actions and display their results.

5.14 Economy Balance Guidelines

- Starting coins support a viable opening formation.
- Players can reasonably fill essential offense and defense roles.
- Two-coin rerolls create meaningful tradeoffs.
- Merging is strategically relevant but not automatic victory.
- Three-star units are possible without being guaranteed.
- Nine bench slots offer sufficient flexibility.
- 2-0 bonuses do not create excessive snowballing.
- Early losses allow meaningful recovery opportunities.
- Finalists have competitive rosters.
- Shop-disabled championship outcomes remain fair and understandable.

Balance should reward planning without allowing early economic advantage to determine the whole tournament.

5.15 MVP Acceptance Criteria

- Configured starting coin balance; balances never negative.
- Exactly five shop offers.
- Affordable purchases work; rerolls cost exactly two coins.
- Purchases and rerolls are disabled during battle.
- Nine-slot bench and valid bench-to-arena movement.
- Invalid purchases deduct no coins.
- Three matching same-star units merge into an upgraded unit.
- Star upgrades unlock the correct card capacity.
- Base income and applicable 2-0 bonuses are awarded.
- Eliminated players stop future economy participation.
- Shop disabled during championship rematch.

• All session economy data resets for a new tournament.

Section 5 - Items Requiring Confirmation

Item	Status
Starting coins	To be confirmed
Base round income	To be confirmed
2-0 bonus amount	To be confirmed
Individual character prices	To be confirmed
Shop offer probabilities	To be confirmed
Shop reroll cost	Confirmed: 2 coins
Shop offer count	Confirmed: 5
Bench capacity	Confirmed: 9
Merge requirement	Confirmed: 3 identical same-star units
Maximum star level	Confirmed: 3
Championship shop restriction	Confirmed: shop disabled
Merge inheritance priority	Provisional

Draft note: Values and rules identified as provisional must be reviewed before this section becomes the authoritative implementation specification.